



Logline:

Four women, all bound by a toxic connection to the same powerful and abusive man, become the prime suspects in his shocking murder. To protect themselves, they forge a fragile alliance and create a shared alibi. But as the investigation intensifies and their lies unravel, they realize the real killer has been listening all along and she's closer than they ever imagined.

Tone:

- **Elegant. Tense. Unpredictable.**
 - Prestige thriller with a noir edge.
 - Blends *Big Little Lies* sophistication with *Knives Out* mystery and *The Undoing* psychological suspense.
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Theme:

- The destructive ripple of abuse and power.
 - How women navigate survival, trust, and betrayal when forced into impossible choices.
 - Sisterhood forged in suspicion and ultimately, strength.
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Pitch:

The Alibi is a **female-driven, twist-forward thriller** designed for today's prestige TV/film landscape. It's a story where **every character is both suspect and victim**, ensuring viewers remain hooked until the final reveal. With a built-in ensemble appeal and strong social commentary about women reclaiming agency, the film is both **marketable to mainstream audiences** and **positioned for critical buzz**.

Detailed Synopsis:

When a wealthy businessman is found murdered in his penthouse, suspicion falls immediately on the four women closest to him:

- his bitter **ex-wife**, still scarred from their public divorce,
- his ambitious **business partner**, fighting to hold her place,
- his frightened **mistress**, desperate to escape,
- and his rebellious **estranged daughter**, who made her hatred of him very public.

Each has motive. Each has secrets. Pressured by police and the media, they form a pact: create one airtight alibi. But as their stories twist and conflict, cracks form. Loyalties are tested. Trust is impossible.

By Act III, they discover the truth: the killer is **Greta, the seemingly invisible personal assistant**, who has orchestrated everything to frame one of them. In a tense showdown, the women, once enemies, must unite to expose her before she destroys them all.

Outline:

- **Act I – Setup:** Murder discovered, suspects introduced, motives established.
 - **Act II – The Pact:** Women agree to form an alibi; pressure from police and media mounts; mistrust grows.
 - **Act III – Revelation & Confrontation:** Assistant revealed as true killer; women unite to stop her.
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Character Breakdown:

Eleanor – The Ex-Wife

- 48, intelligent, resourceful, but scarred by betrayal.
- Motivation: Survival, financial security, dignity.

Jasmine – The Business Partner

- 39, ambitious, sharp, forced out of the company.
- Motivation: Justice, protecting her reputation.

Sienna – The Mistress

- 25, fragile yet cunning beneath the surface.
- Motivation: Escape, independence.

Zoe – The Estranged Daughter

- 20, rebellious, public disdain for father.
- Motivation: Freedom from his shadow.

Greta – The Personal Assistant (Antagonist)

- 50s, invisible, meticulous, secretly in love with the victim.
 - Motivation: Revenge, obsession.
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Talent Suggestions:

Eleanor: Nicole Kidman | Angela Bassett | Julia Roberts

Jasmine: Kerry Washington | Thandiwe Newton | Gabrielle Union

Sienna: Sydney Sweeney | Florence Pugh | Ana de Armas

Zoe: Amandla Stenberg | Sophie Turner | Chloe Bailey

Greta: Toni Collette | Patricia Clarkson | Annette Bening

ALIBI



ANGELA BASSETT
ELEANOR



GABRIELLE UNION
JASMINE



ANA DE ARMAS
SIENNA



CHLOE BAILEY
ZOE

**PATRICIA
CLARKSON**
GRETA



Director Match Suggestions:

- **Susanne Bier** (*The Undoing*)
 - **Ava DuVernay** (*When They See Us*)
 - **Karyn Kusama** (*Destroyer*, *The Invitation*)
 - **Andrea Arnold** (*Big Little Lies*, *American Honey*)
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Lookbook / Mood Reel References:

- Visual textures of *Big Little Lies* (wealth vs. darkness).
 - Sleek, noir-inspired interiors (*The Undoing*).
 - Tension-driven ensemble staging (*Knives Out*).
 - Cinematic color palette: emerald green, deep navy, golden accents, shadow contrasts.
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Marketing Hooks & Taglines:

- "Four suspects. One alibi. No one's telling the truth."
 - "What if protecting yourself meant protecting your enemy?"
 - "The killer isn't who you think, it's who's been watching."
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Target Audience & Market:

- **Networks:** Lifetime, OWN, BET, Paramount+, Netflix.
 - **Audience:** Female-skewing 25–54 demo; thriller enthusiasts; fans of prestige dramas with mystery hooks.
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Core Audience:

- Viewers of *Big Little Lies*, *The Undoing*, *Sharp Objects*.
- Women-driven social media communities engaged in mystery/thrillers.

- Fans of ensemble casts and layered female characters.
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Why It Sells:

- Female ensemble = broad casting and marketing appeal.
 - Thrillers are top-performing for streamers and cable networks.
 - Built-in twist ending ensures strong word-of-mouth and rewatch value.
 - Timely themes of abuse, power, and solidarity resonate with modern audiences.
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Comparable Films & Series:

- *Big Little Lies* – female ensemble drama.
 - *Knives Out* – stylish, character-driven mystery.
 - *The Undoing* – psychological intrigue with a glamorous sheen.
 - *Gone Girl* – dark, twisty, addictive.
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Production Value:

- Stylish, prestige-level visuals but budget-friendly as a contained mystery.
 - Limited locations: penthouse, police station, private residences.
 - Ensemble cast carries most of the dramatic weight.
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Story & Hook – Why This Story Matters Now:

In an era of heightened awareness around power, abuse, and women's agency, *The Alibi* provides a compelling, stylish thriller that also resonates with today's cultural conversations. It's not just about "who did it," but about the **cost of silence, survival, and solidarity**.

Demographics:

- Women 25–54 (core Lifetime/OWN/BET+ demo).
 - Secondary: Broader thriller audience across streaming (18–49).
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Marketability:

- Strong ensemble casting opportunities with crossover star appeal.
- Festival-friendly as a prestige mystery-thriller.
- Trailer and poster-ready hook (“Four suspects. One murder. One killer watching them all.”).
- Perfect fit for streamer binge audiences craving female-led suspense.

TREATMENT: *THE ALIBI*

SUMMARY:

Eleanor Hayes has spent her life building a reputation, brilliant legal mind, pillar of the community, a seemingly perfect marriage to Jordan, a charming real estate developer. She’s poised for a political appointment, admired for her poise, intellect, and composure.

But one morning, Eleanor wakes up to a nightmare: her husband is gone, and a woman she’s never seen before is lying dead next to her in their marital bed. No signs of forced entry. No signs of a struggle. No memory of what happened.

Rather than call the police, Eleanor makes a calculated decision, she cleans the scene. Hides the body. Constructs an alibi. She knows how the system works and how quickly it turns on Black women.

She enlists help from her best friend **Jasmine**, a sharp-tongued crisis PR fixer who agrees to help, though she’s not sure if Eleanor is a victim or a suspect. Together, they craft a narrative to protect Eleanor’s career, her image, and her freedom.

But secrets don’t stay buried.

A series of cryptic text messages begin arriving from an unknown number: *“I know what you did.”* The stranger’s identity is revealed, she was an escort. Her connection to Jordan becomes undeniable.

Surveillance footage surfaces that contradicts Eleanor's timeline.

And the final nail: a security camera shows Eleanor driving away from her house the night before, with the dead woman in her passenger seat.

Is someone framing her? Was Jordan involved in something darker than she knew? Or is Eleanor guilty of more than she remembers?

As the investigation intensifies, Eleanor's carefully constructed reality begins to collapse. Her legal expertise becomes her weapon but also her trap. Her alibi becomes the battleground.

In the final act, Eleanor confronts the truth: Jordan staged the entire thing. He faked his own disappearance and framed her to avoid exposure in a major corruption scandal involving sex trafficking and city contracts. The body was a setup. The camera footage was manipulated.

But Eleanor turns the tables. Using her legal mind and Jordan's arrogance against him, she sets a new trap, one that ends with him caught in the exact same system he thought he controlled.

In a stunning climax, Eleanor delivers a televised press conference not to defend herself but to dismantle the narrative. She admits to cleaning the scene, not because she was guilty but because she was terrified. Her truth becomes her power.

The film ends not with total exoneration but with reclamation. Eleanor doesn't walk away unscathed but she walks away **in control of her story**.



ALIBI BUDGET ASSUMPTIONS

BUDGET: \$3.5 MILLION

Schedule:

- · 20 Day prep
- · 20 Day Shoot

- · 15 Day Wrap
- · 6 Week Post

Writer:

- Budget assumes \$90,153 Writer fees with WGA
- Budget assumes \$20,000 Production bonus

Producer:

- Budget assumes \$250,000 Producer Fees

Director:

- DGA Director \$110,000

Cast Assumptions:

- Cast Lead #1 \$225,000
- Cast Lead #2 \$225,000
- Cast Lead #3 \$100,000
- Cast Lead #4 \$75,000
- Supporting cast sag scale

Production & Creative Assumptions:

- The budget assumes filming on location in Atlanta, GA
- Local D.P.
- 2 Stand-ins ROS
- 135 BG
- Shot on Stage/Location

Post Production:

- Allowance for 2 Editors and 2 Assistant Editor
- Composer \$75,000

Tax Credit & Financial Assumption: Georgia State Tax Credit \$750,000